



Missing Someone Who Hurt You

Why it happens and how to stay safe while you heal

digitaldisconnect.shop/guides/why-do-i-miss-my-ex-who-hurt-me

It can feel humiliating to miss someone who lied to you, belittled you or treated you badly. People around you may say "why would you even want them back?" But missing a person who hurt you is very common, and there are understandable reasons for it.

Why it happens

- The good times were real. People who hurt us are rarely all bad, and the good moments stand out.
- Hot-and-cold cycles: periods of affection after periods of hurt can create a very strong bond.
- Familiarity: even a painful relationship becomes home, and leaving home is frightening.
- Self-doubt: after being criticised for a long time, you may wonder if it was really your fault.

Missing them isn't a reason to go back

Feelings and decisions are separate. You can miss someone deeply and still know that going back would hurt you. Write down specific things that happened, with dates if you can remember them. When the missing gets loud, read the list.

Why no contact matters more here

People who've hurt us are often good at pulling us back with apologies, promises or guilt. No contact, including blocking if needed, protects you from that pull while your judgement recovers.

Rebuild your trust in yourself

- Talk to people who saw what the relationship was really like
- Write down what you know to be true about yourself
- Notice how you feel in your body around people who treat you well
- Consider a counsellor, especially if the relationship was controlling or abusive

If you were in an abusive relationship

If your ex was controlling, threatening or violent, please get specialist support. In the US, the National Domestic Violence Hotline is available at 1-800-799-7233. If you're in immediate

danger, call 911 or your local emergency number.

YOUR NOTES

What I'm taking from this guide

NEXT STEP

Put it into practice for 30 days.

The No-Contact Journal is a printable 30-day guided journal: 90 prompts, a daily no-contact check-in, and a "Before you text them" page for the moments you're about to reach out.

Get it at digitaldisconnect.shop

Or start free with the 3-day starter at digitaldisconnect.shop/free

This guide is general self-help information, not therapy, medical or legal advice. If you're thinking about harming yourself, in the US call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or contact your local emergency number.

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